

# Moose

The world's biggest species of deer also has one of the widest ranges. The moose is an animal of marshy forests and is found across temperate regions of the northern hemisphere—where there is plenty of vegetation to browse and cover for females to raise their calves.



## Motherly care

A female moose gives birth to one or two calves and feeds them with milk for up to five months. The thick cover of the northern forests helps protect them from predatory gray wolves and brown bears.

## Bellowing bull

During the breeding season, most male moose defend a female by bellowing loudly and thrashing the vegetation aggressively with their antlers to warn other males to stay away.

## Mountain forests

In Asia, moose are widespread throughout the forests of Siberia. They are found at their highest altitude in central Asia, including up to 5,580 ft (1,700 m) above sea level in the Altai Mountains.

## Shrinking range

In prehistory, moose were found as far west as the British Isles and the Pyrenees. Hunting restricted them to Scandinavia and eastern Europe, but their numbers here have increased in the last 50 years.

## Giant antlers

Like almost all other deer, only male moose grow antlers. These enormous bony weapons—each more than 3 ft (1 m) long—grow new each year as males defend their mates and territories, before being shed at the end of each breeding season.

